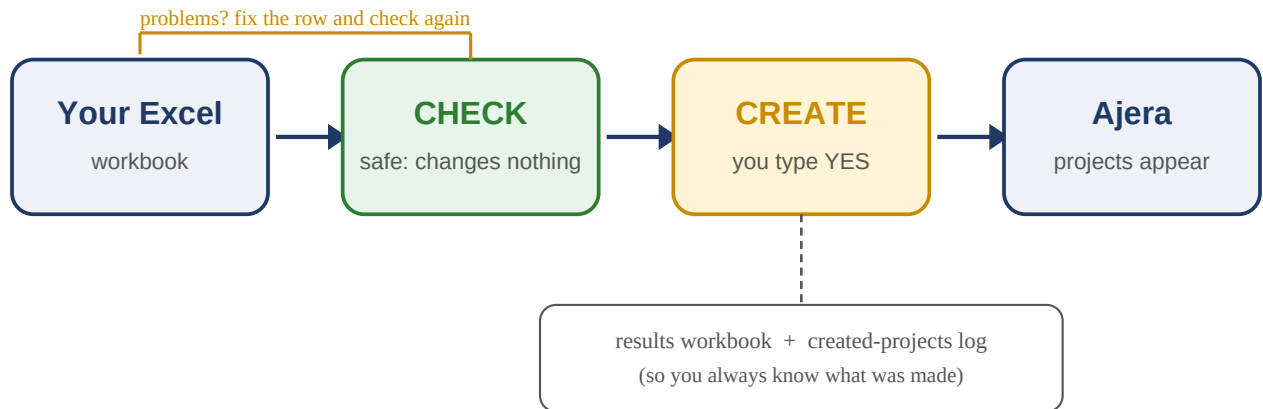


Ajera Project Import

Create projects in Deltek Ajera from an Excel spreadsheet



A plain-language guide for the people who set up projects. No programming needed.

Version 1.0 · September 2026 · github.com/paulnew2000/ajera-project-import

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1. What this tool does

Setting up a new project in Ajera normally means clicking through several screens for each job. With this tool you **list your new projects in a spreadsheet**, one row per project, and it creates them in Ajera for you, correctly and all in one go.

It always works in two steps:

Step	What happens	Does it change Ajera?
CHECK	Reads your spreadsheet and compares every name (client, department, rate table, people...) with what is in Ajera. Lists anything that doesn't match, by row.	No, never
CREATE	Runs the check again, then makes the projects. Only runs if every row passed, and only after you type YES.	Yes

The one thing to remember

Ajera's API **cannot delete projects**. Once CREATE makes a project, only a person working in Ajera can remove it. That's why the tool checks everything first, asks you to type YES, and keeps a log of every project it makes. See section 7.

2. Before you start

You need three things. The first two are a one-time job for whoever looks after Ajera and your computer.

You need	Who sets it up	Details
Ajera API access	Your Ajera administrator	An API user (name + password) and the API web address . The API user must be allowed to create projects. The README lists the exact permissions.
Python	You or IT (5 minutes)	Free, from python.org. During install, tick Add python.exe to PATH .
A practice database	Your Ajera administrator (recommended)	An Ajera sandbox or test copy, where you can try things without affecting real projects.

3. One-time setup

Good to know before you start

- **Tested at one firm so far.** The tool has been tested end to end against one firm's Ajera sandbox. Every firm sets up Ajera a little differently (several companies, which API permissions are switched on, and so on), so your first run may turn up something new. Try it in your **sandbox** first. If you see an error, it's safe to forward: messages never include client or staff names.
- **Made for Windows.** The double-click menu (*Ajera Project Import.bat*) only works on Windows. On a Mac, the same steps are run by typing short commands in Terminal. The README lists them, and someone comfortable with Terminal can set it up in a few minutes.

- 1 Download the tool from GitHub (green **Code** button, then **Download ZIP**) and unzip it to a folder you'll remember, such as *Documents\Ajera Project Import*.
- 2 Double-click **Ajera Project Import.bat**. The first time, it installs what it needs (about a minute) and opens a settings file in Notepad.
- 3 In Notepad, paste the **API web address**, **user name** and **password** from your administrator after the = signs. Save and close Notepad.
- 4 Choose **1 - Check connection**. It shows a **DatabaseID** number. Confirm with your administrator that this is the database you want (ideally the sandbox), then choose **6** and type that number after **AJERA_EXPECTED_DB_ID=**. Until this is filled in, the tool refuses to create anything.

This is the menu you'll see each time:

```
=====
                AJERA PROJECT IMPORT
=====
1 Check connection (which database am I on?)
2 Make a blank template from my Ajera
3 CHECK a workbook (safe - changes nothing)
4 CREATE projects from a workbook
5 Show projects this tool has created
6 Open the settings file (.env)
7 Make the Hogwarts sample ready for MY Ajera
Q Quit
```

Keep the settings file private

The settings file (**.env**) holds your Ajera password. Don't email it or put it on a shared drive. Everyone who uses the tool should have their own.

4. Creating projects: the everyday routine

- 1 Get a template.** Menu option **2** makes *Ajera Project Import - template.xlsx* in the tool's folder. Its **Lookups** sheet lists your Ajera's clients, departments, project types, rate tables, project managers and principals, and the spreadsheet's drop-down lists use them. Make a fresh template now and then so new clients appear.
- 2 Fill it in.** One row per project on the **Projects** sheet. Add rows on the **Phases** sheet if a project needs more than one phase (section 5).
- 3 CHECK it.** Option **3**, then pick your file. You'll either see **All good** or a list such as *Projects row 4, Client: not found in Ajera*. Fix those rows, save, and check again.
- 4 CREATE.** Option **4**, pick the same file, and type **YES** when asked. Each project is created and then read back from Ajera to confirm it's really there.
- 5 Look at the results.** A copy of your spreadsheet is saved next to it, named *...results_<date-time>.xlsx*. It has three new columns: **Result**, **Ajera Project Key** and **Message**.

Good habits

- Always CHECK before CREATE. It costs nothing and changes nothing.
- Keep each spreadsheet small (a day's or a week's new jobs), so problems are easy to find.
- Once a file has been created, don't run CREATE on it again. The Job IDs now exist, so the check will stop you anyway.

5. Filling in the spreadsheet

Dark-blue column headings must be filled in; light-blue ones are optional. Hover over a heading in Excel for a reminder. Spelling must match Ajera, but capital letters and extra spaces don't matter.

Projects sheet: one row per project

Column	Required?	What to enter
Job ID	Yes	Your project number. It must not already exist in Ajera.
Description	Yes	The project name.
Client	Yes	Pick from the list. The client must already exist in Ajera.
Department	Yes	Pick from the list.
Project Type	Yes	Pick from the list.
Billing Type	Yes	Time and Expense, Fixed Fee, Percent Complete, Unit Price, Nonbillable...
Rate Table	Yes	The billing rate table. Ajera insists on one.
Project Manager	No	Pick from the list (only people set up as project managers).
Principal in Charge	No	Pick from the list (only people set up as principals).
Status	No	Active (the default) or Preliminary.
Start / End Date	No	Estimated dates.
Invoice Group	No	A name for the billing group. Leave blank for <i>Invoice Group 1</i> .
Invoice Format	No	Pick from the list.
Notes	No	Anything you like; it's copied into the project's Notes.

Phases sheet: optional

Phases are the pieces of a project that staff charge time to. Add one row per phase, using the same **Job ID** as the project. **If you add no phases, the project gets one phase called *General***, so time can be charged straight away.

Column	Required?	What to enter
Job ID	Yes	The project this phase belongs to.
Phase Description	Yes	e.g. <i>Task 1 - Field Work</i> .
Department	No	Leave blank to use the project's department.
Billing Type	No	Leave blank to use the project's billing type.

Two people or clients with the same name? The Lookups sheet shows a **Key** number next to each name. Type that number instead of the name, and the tool will know exactly which one you mean.

6. What the messages mean

Every message tells you the **sheet**, the **row number** and the **column**. It deliberately doesn't repeat what you typed, so you can safely forward a message to a colleague or IT.

Message	What to do
...not found in Ajera	Spelling doesn't match Ajera. Choose from the drop-down, or check the Lookups sheet. If it's brand new in Ajera, make a fresh template.
...already exists in Ajera	That Job ID is taken. Use a different number.
...is also used on row N	The same Job ID appears twice in your spreadsheet.
...is required	A dark-blue column was left empty.
...matches more than one Ajera record	Two records share that name. Type the Key number from the Lookups sheet instead.
...not flagged as a Project Manager / Principal	Ajera only accepts people set up that way. Pick someone else, or ask your administrator.
...does not match any Job ID on the Projects sheet	A Phases row points at a project that isn't on the Projects sheet (often a typo).
...is not a date / is before the Start Date	Fix the date.
Writes are BLOCKED / AJERA_EXPECTED_DB_ID...	The safety switch is working: the settings don't say you meant to write to this database. See section 3, step 4.
Could not sign in to Ajera	The user name, password or web address in the settings file is wrong, or the API user is disabled.
Ajera refused it: ...	Ajera itself said no during CREATE. The rest of the message says why. Other rows still go ahead, and the results file shows which were made.

7. Projects can't be deleted by this tool

Why this matters

Ajera's API, the doorway this tool uses, has no delete button. A project created by mistake has to be removed by a person, inside Ajera.

To make that easy, the tool **writes down every project the moment Ajera creates it**, in a file called **created_projects.csv** in the tool's folder. Menu option **5** shows the list. Each line records:

- when it was created and in which database (DatabaseID)
- the **Ajera Project Key** (Ajera's internal number) and the **Job ID**
- the description and which spreadsheet it came from

How to clean up test projects

- 1 Open the log (option 5, or open created_projects.csv in Excel).
- 2 In Ajera, find each project by its Job ID.
- 3 Delete it. Ajera only allows this while nothing has been charged or billed to the project. If anything has been, set its status to **Inactive** instead.

Tip: give practice projects an obviously fake Job ID, such as **HP001**. They're easy to spot, and they can't clash with a real job number.

8. Built-in safety features

Feature	What it protects against
CHECK changes nothing	You can check as often as you like.
All-or-nothing check	If any row has a problem, nothing at all is created, so you never end up with half a batch.
Type YES to create	Creating by accident.
Database safety switch	Writing test data into your live Ajera because the wrong web address was pasted. The tool only writes to the database number in the settings.
Read-back check	Ajera sometimes says "success" without actually creating anything. The tool looks for each new project before reporting success.
Created-projects log	Losing track of what was made (section 7).
Messages don't repeat your data	Client and staff names leaking when you share an error message.

9. Try it with the Hogwarts sample

The **examples** folder has **Hogwarts sample projects.xlsx**: ten obviously fictional projects that show how a finished spreadsheet looks. For example:

Job ID	Description	Client	Billing Type
HP001	Test Project: Dumbledore	Gringotts Wizarding Bank	Time and Expense
HP002	Test Project: McGonagall	Ministry of Magic	Time and Expense
HP003	Test Project: Hagrid	Hogwarts School of Witchcraft and Wizardry	Fixed Fee

Gringotts and Gryffindor aren't in your Ajera, so if you **CHECK** the sample as it is, those names are listed as *not found*. That's a harmless way to see what the messages look like.

Make the sample ready for your Ajera: one menu option

- 1 Ask your administrator which **test or placeholder client** the practice projects should go on (many firms have one, such as *New Client* or *Test Client*).
- 2 Choose menu option **7**. Type that client's name, or just press Enter to let the tool look for a client with *test* or *placeholder* in its name.
- 3 The tool saves **Hogwarts sample - ready for my Ajera.xlsx** and checks it straight away. The Harry Potter project names, notes and phases stay, and the client, departments, project types and rate table are swapped for real ones from your Ajera. Nothing in Ajera is changed.
- 4 Open the file and look it over. Then use option **4 - CREATE**, in your **sandbox**. The Job IDs start at HP001, or continue after any HP numbers you've already used.

10. Optional: use it by asking an AI assistant

If you use Claude Desktop (or another assistant that supports *MCP* tools), IT can connect this tool to it using the instructions in the README. You can then just ask:

- "Which Ajera database is the project import tool connected to?"
- "Check the spreadsheet *New jobs.xlsx* in my Documents folder."
- "Those look right. Create them."

The assistant uses the same **CHECK** and **CREATE** steps and safety features. It must ask for your go-ahead before creating anything.

11. Words you'll see

Term	Meaning
API	The "side door" that lets programs talk to Ajera without clicking through screens.
API user	A special Ajera login, used only by programs like this one.
Sandbox	A practice copy of Ajera. Changes there don't affect your real data.

Term	Meaning
DatabaseID	The number that identifies which Ajera database (live or sandbox) you're connected to.
Project Key	Ajera's own internal number for a project (different from your Job ID).
Phase	A part of a project that people charge time to.
Invoice group	How Ajera groups phases for billing. This tool makes one per project, billed to the client.
Rate table	The list of billing rates Ajera uses to price time on the project.